

The Prompt Engineering Cheat Sheet for Business Users

Better prompts, better output — whether you use ChatGPT, Copilot or Claude. From RPATech's Applied AI & Prompt Engineering program, already teaching 200,000+ learners worldwide.

The 4-part anatomy of a strong prompt

1

Role & instruction

Tell it who to be and exactly what to do.
"Summarize" is weak; "Summarize for a CFO in 5 bullets" is strong.

2

Context

Paste the background: the document, the audience, the constraint. AI can't read your mind — it can read your paste.

3

Example

Show one sample of the output you want (format, tone, length). One good example beats three paragraphs of description.

4

Iterate

Treat the first answer as a draft. Reply with "shorter", "more formal", "as a table" — refining beats restarting.

Template: "You are a [role]. [Task] for [audience]. Use this context: [paste]. Match this example: [sample]. Format as [format], max [length]."

Copy-paste prompts for daily work

✉ Email drafting

"Draft a polite but firm follow-up email to a vendor who missed Friday's delivery deadline. Audience: their account manager. Tone: professional, keeps the relationship. Under 120 words. End with a clear ask for a revised date."

📄 Document summarizing

"Summarize the document below for someone who has 2 minutes. Give: 3 key points, 2 risks, 1 recommended action. Use plain language, no jargon. [paste document]"

📅 Meeting notes → actions

"From these meeting notes, extract a table with columns: Action, Owner, Due date, Blocked by. Flag any action with no owner. [paste notes]"

📄 SOP writing

"Turn my rough steps below into a numbered SOP a new joiner could follow without help. Add a 'common mistakes' section at the end. [paste steps]"

📄 BRD & test cases

"Act as a business analyst. From this process description, draft: (1) requirements as user stories, (2) 5 test cases including 2 exception scenarios, (3) open questions for the process owner. [paste description]"

🔍 Spotting automation opportunities

"Here's how my team spends a typical week: [describe]. Identify the 3 tasks most suitable for automation, and for each say why: rule-based, high volume, or repetitive judgment."

Fix a weak prompt in one pass

Weak prompt	Strong prompt
"Write an email about the delay"	"Write a 100-word email to my manager explaining the report is delayed 2 days due to missing vendor data. Include the new date and what I'm doing to prevent repeats."
"Summarize this"	"Summarize this 12-page policy into a half-page brief for frontline staff. Focus only on what changes for them from next month."
"Make a plan for the project"	"Create a 6-week rollout plan for [project] with weekly milestones, owners as placeholders, and the top 3 risks with mitigations. Format as a table."
"Is this good?"	"Review this draft as a skeptical senior manager. List: unclear sentences, unsupported claims, and one suggestion to strengthen the opening."

Where AI is reliable — and where it isn't

✓ Trust it for

Drafting and rewriting text · summarizing documents you provide · reformatting (notes → table, text → bullets) · brainstorming options · explaining concepts · translating tone ("make this friendlier")

✗ Verify before using

Facts, figures and dates it produces from memory · citations and links · legal, HR or compliance language · anything going to a customer or regulator · calculations — ask it to show working

Safe enterprise use — 5 rules

#	Rule
1	Never paste customer PII, credentials or confidential financials into public AI tools — use only approved tool.
2	Know your company's AI policy: which tools are approved, and for which data classes.
3	You own the output. AI drafts; you approve. Your name is on it, not the model's.
4	Verify anything factual before it leaves your desk — models state wrong things confidently.
5	Keep a personal prompt library. When a prompt works, save it — that's your compounding productivity asset.

Pro habit: End tricky prompts with "Ask me up to 3 clarifying questions before answering." Quality jumps immediately.



Want your whole team working like this?

RPATech's 1-day **Applied AI & Prompt Engineering** workshop runs a business track and a developer track from one shared core — every participant leaves with a prompt library for their real work.

[Get Started →](#)